

ing wolf, it would by no means follow that one tyrant might claim a right to destroy another, merely to take his place. The people of Florence were now so totally devoted to the Medici family, that there was no party among them but what was headed by some branch of it: the blood of the Medici must in all events govern them; and the difference between them was worth very little. Strozzi and Lorenzo were worse than Alexander; and the only tolerably good man among them was Cosimo, whom they all hated, but whom Providence was pleased to call to the government in this awful manner. The silly tales of prognostics, the enthusiasm of the disciples of Savanarola, and the confusions and terrors among the principal people upon the first suspicion and final discovery of the duke's destiny, are not worth repeating. The council of forty-eight were assembled, but were not agreed in opinion. Canigiani proposed, that in place of the deceased duke, Guilio, his natural son, should succeed; but there was no other person present, who did not either smile at his folly, or express an indignation; for besides that the child was not five years old, this was known to be the inclination and secret motion of cardinal Cibo, Lorenzo's brother, who wished to be the tutor, and therefore governor of the city. After him was proposed the signor Cosimo de Medici, who knowing nothing of what had happened, was at Mugello, fifteen miles from Florence, at his country seat of Trebbio. At this nomination all appeared to be struck, and looking at one another, seemed ready to accept it, every one knowing that Cosimo was the next heir, after Lorenzo, according to the declaration of the emperor; but Palla Rucellai, without doubt in favour of Philip Strozzi, to whom he was attached, opposed warmly
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